

# Studio — Owner's Manual

Everything Studio does, in the order you'd actually use it. Updated August 2026 · build b0804

**The one rule that explains everything:** Studio has two kinds of actions. **FREE** is everything that edits, assembles, styles, cuts, captions, or exports — use it as much as you want, forever, no cost. **COSTS** is only AI *generating* — making new pictures, animating a still into video, AI voice, lip-sync, and the one-time face-lock training. Every paid button shows its price before you tap it, and nothing ever spends without a click.

## Turning on AI (one time)

The header shows **AI READY** when it's on. If it doesn't: ⚙ **Settings** → **Turn on AI**, paste your fal.ai key. That key is what paid actions spend from. While you're in Settings, set a **Daily spend cap** — it makes going over impossible.

**Check your build:** the small number in the header should read `b0804` . If it's lower, your browser is running old files — go to **Profile** → **Update my app**, then restart Studio.

## The six tabs

| Tab                                                                                                 | What it's for                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>My Media</b> | Your library. Everything you upload, generate, or render lands here — and every tool lives on the item itself. |
| <b>AI Scenes</b>                                                                                    | Type a description, get a picture. <b>COSTS</b>                                                                |
| <b>Characters</b>                                                                                   | Face-lock: teach Studio your face once so it's the same person in every video.                                 |
| <b>Sequencer</b>                                                                                    | Where pictures + music become a finished video. Also holds Quick Make and the template gallery.                |
|  <b>Post</b>     | Scripts, the teleprompter, the webcam recorder, and your posting schedule.                                     |
|  <b>Settings</b> | Keys, spend cap, storage, backup, updates, guide.                                                              |

## Recording yourself (free, start here)

- 1 Post tab** → paste your script → **Save script**.
- 2 ► Open teleprompter**. Set the speed — it goes down to half-steps if the normal slow is still too fast.

- 3  **Record my webcam.** Options before you start: countdown (3s/5s/10s), background blur or replace, and photo mode.
- 4 Read it. Look at the lens, not the words — glance down only between lines. Tap to stop.
- 5 It lands in **My Media**. Then: **transcribe** →  **Reframe 9:16** → ✨ **Master for release** → ↓ **Download**.

**Looking natural:** record two or three takes back to back and keep the third. The first is stiff, the second is careful, the third is you.

## My Media — every tool, what it does, and what it costs

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### Motion & shape FREE

| Button                                                                                                  | What it does                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Motion</b> (pictures)                                                                                | Sends the picture to the Sequencer for Ken Burns motion — slow push, pull, pan, drift.                                                                                         |
| <b>Loop</b>                                                                                             | Stretches a short clip by playing it forward, backward, forward. No jump at the seams.                                                                                         |
| <b>Slow-mo</b>                                                                                          | Half speed.                                                                                                                                                                    |
|  <b>Motion blur</b>    | Blends neighbouring frames so fast movement smears silky and hard cuts read softer.                                                                                            |
| <b>Mirror</b>                                                                                           | Flips left-to-right.                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Freeze</b>                                                                                           | Grabs a still out of a clip so you can reuse the moment as a picture.                                                                                                          |
| <b>Crop / Cut</b>                                                                                       | Trim a picture's edges / cut a clip's length.                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Sound</b>                                                                                            | Swap or adjust a clip's audio.                                                                                                                                                 |
|  <b>Green screen</b> | Shot on a solid colour? Drop yourself onto any picture or clip.                                                                                                                |
|  <b>Reframe</b>      | Turns anything into vertical 9:16, square 1:1, or wide 16:9. <i>Fill</i> crops to the frame; <i>blur</i> keeps the whole shot with a blurred background so nothing is cut off. |

### Finishing FREE

| Button                                                                                                        | What it does                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Polish my video</b>    | One tap: cinematic grade + sharpen + loudness master. Best on a finished render.                              |
|  <b>Look</b>               | Six colour themes for the whole clip — Dark Luxury, Neon Night, Cinematic, Warm Film, Vibrant, Black & White. |
|  <b>Dynamics</b>           | Ten CapCut-style beat effects. See the next page — this is the big one.                                       |
| <b>2× sharper</b>                                                                                             | Doubles a picture's resolution.                                                                               |
|  <b>Clean audio</b>        | De-noise, de-rumble, even out the volume. Great for phone-recorded narration.                                 |
|  <b>Master for release</b> | Full repair + a release-ready 48kHz/24-bit file that uploads anywhere.                                        |
|  <b>Take the voice out</b> | Lifts the sound off a clip into its own audio file, cleaned up. Reuse it as narration.                        |

AI on an item

COSTS

| Button                                                                                  | What it does & roughly what it costs                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Animate                                                                                 | Turns a still into moving video. <b>Draft</b> \$0.05/sec · <b>Standard</b> \$0.07/sec (this is Kling 2.5 Turbo Pro) · <b>Best</b> \$0.24/sec (save it for hero shots). |
| Sing                                                                                    | Lip-syncs a face to audio.                                                                                                                                             |
|  Shots | Generates coverage — extra angles of the same scene.                                                                                                                   |
|  QC    | AI checks a shot for off-model faces, bad hands, continuity slips.                                                                                                     |

**Money rule:** a 5-second shot costs about **\$0.44** all-in (picture + Standard animate). A 5-shot, 25-second AI video is roughly **\$2.20**. Use Draft or Standard — never "Best" for social.

# 🔥 Dynamics — the CapCut-style effects

Tap 🔥 **Dynamics** on any **video or picture**. A picture becomes a moving clip — pick how long (4, 6, 8, 10 or 15 seconds). A video keeps its exact length and its music in sync. Every one makes a **new copy**; your original is never touched. All free, no AI.

**Hit speed** — Fast (1s), Normal (2s), Slow (4s) — sets how often the effects punch. Match it to your song.

| Template              | What it looks like                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 🔥 <b>Beat Mix</b>     | Rotates clean → black-and-white punch → thermal heat-vision → glow pulse, with a white flash on every beat. The closest thing to a full CapCut edit in one tap.                      |
| ⚡ <b>B/W Strobe</b>   | Black-and-white hits landing on the beat.                                                                                                                                            |
| 💜 <b>Color Flip</b>   | Vivid purple colour flips on the beat.                                                                                                                                               |
| 🔥 <b>Thermal</b>      | The whole clip in red-orange heat-vision.                                                                                                                                            |
| ✨ <b>Glow Up</b>      | Soft dreamy glow around the subject.                                                                                                                                                 |
| 👤 <b>Echo Trails</b>  | Movement leaves ghost trails behind it.                                                                                                                                              |
| 📱 <b>Hype Shake</b>   | Handheld camera-shake energy with beat flashes.                                                                                                                                      |
| 🌀 <b>Mirror World</b> | Kaleidoscope mirror split.                                                                                                                                                           |
| 🕒 <b>Time Machine</b> | First half plays as a worn old photo — sepia, film grain, dark corners — then a white flash, and it returns sharper and more vibrant than the original. Works on pictures and video. |
| 🕒 <b>3-2-1 Opener</b> | Big countdown numbers over your first three seconds.                                                                                                                                 |

**Stack them.** Run Beat Mix, then run 3-2-1 Opener on the result. Each pass is another free copy.

## Sequencer — pictures + music → video

### Quick Make (the fast path)

- 1 **Add your pictures** (and clips, if you have them).
- 2 **Add music** — import a song or pick one from your library.
- 3 **Tap a premade look** — see the table below. It sets the motion, timing and transitions for every shot at once.
- 4 **Assemble** → wait → **download**.

| Look | Feel |
|------|------|
|------|------|

|                                                                                                     |                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Punch</b>      | Fast beat cuts, hard zooms — trending-short energy.       |
|  <b>Hype</b>       | Shake + zoom, hard cuts. Highest energy.                  |
|  <b>Cinematic</b>  | Slow pushes and blends — story feel.                      |
|  <b>Smooth</b>     | Gentle floating drift — calm and emotional.               |
|  <b>Quote hold</b> | One long slow push per card. Built for text cards.        |
|  <b>Reveal</b>     | Pull back, dip to black, push in. Built for before/after. |

You can also **save your own template** once you've dialled a look you like, and re-apply it later.

### Ken Burns — the slow push on a still

Per shot you choose the **move** (push in, pull out, pan, drift), the **strength** (0.08 up to Max 0.70), the **direction**, and the **duration** (up to 60 seconds).

#### If motion is cutting off your text cards

Set that shot's fit to **pad** instead of crop. Pad keeps the whole picture in frame and adds bars; crop fills the frame and trims the edges. Text cards want pad — nothing gets chopped.

### Captions

Transcribe first, then set **size** (small / medium / large) and **width** (60–92% of the frame, default 80). If captions cover your face, drop to small and narrow the width — the words wrap instead of running off the edge.

### Output sizes

Six shapes (vertical 9:16, square 1:1, wide 16:9, classic 4:3, portrait 4:5, ultrawide) × four resolutions (720p, 1080p, 1440p, 4K). Vertical 1080p is the right default for TikTok, Reels and Shorts.

## Characters — face-lock

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Do this once and every AI video afterwards has the same face instead of a stranger each time.

- 1 **Characters tab** → new character → upload **2–6 clear photos** of the same person, different angles, good light.
- 2 Train the face-lock. **COSTS** — one time, and it's the single best money you'll spend in Studio.
- 3 From then on, attach that character to your image generations and animations.

Already trained a face somewhere else? Paste the LoRA URL and its trigger word straight into the Characters tab — no retraining.

## AI Scenes — making pictures

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- 1 Type what you want to see. Be specific: who, where, light, mood, camera.
- 2 Pick the model — cheapest is fine for testing, better ones for keepers.
- 3 End every prompt with your style line so all your videos match:  
cinematic photograph, shot on 35mm, shallow depth of field, moody realistic lighting, muted color grade, documentary realism, vertical 9:16
- 4 Generate. It lands in My Media, ready to Animate or send to the Sequencer.

**Prices per picture:** around \$0.035 basic · \$0.07 GPT-Image · \$0.09 with your face-lock · \$0.15 top-tier. The button shows the real number before you tap.

## Post tab

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- **Scripts** — paste and save; the teleprompter reads from here.
- **Teleprompter** — adjustable speed with half-steps at the slow end, and a mirror-friendly band you can still see yourself past.
- **Webcam recorder** — countdown, background blur or replace, photo mode.
- **Schedule** — plan what goes out when, and mark things done or skipped.

## Housekeeping

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### Space

**Settings** → **Storage** shows what you're using. Delete anything you've already downloaded and posted — deleting from the library removes the file from your computer, so download first if you want to keep it. Renders are the big

files; source pictures are small.

## Backup

**Settings** → **Backup** saves your library and settings. Do it before an update.

## Updating

**Profile** → **Update my app**, then restart Studio and reload the page. Confirm the build number in the header changed. If a button you were told about isn't there, the build number is why.

## Money control

- **Daily spend cap** in Settings — a hard stop, not a warning.
- **fal receipts** in Settings — every paid generation with an estimated cost and a running total.
- Check your fal balance before a batch. Batch AI work in one sitting rather than a few a day.

### Subscription question, settled (August 2026)

Don't buy a Kling or Runway subscription at your volume. Studio's **Standard** animate already uses Kling 2.5 Turbo Pro — the same engine those \$32/month plans sell. Pay-per-use runs about \$0.44 a shot, so 4–5 AI videos a month costs \$13–26 and a quiet month costs nothing. Break-even against a subscription is roughly **6 minutes of animated video per month**. Go past that regularly and it's worth revisiting.

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**Studio · Owner's Manual · August 2026 · build b0804.** Free: assembling, cutting, transitions, captions, looks, Dynamics, polish, reframing, mastering, templates, export, backups. Costs money: AI pictures, Animate, AI voice, lip-sync, face-lock training — always priced on the button before you tap.